

DHRUV CHAVDA

Senior DevOps Engineer

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ABOUT ME

CKA- and ICA-certified DevOps/SRE Engineer with **4+ years** of experience building secure, automated, and **AI-ready** Kubernetes platforms across cloud environments. Specialized in scaling infrastructure from **0 to 1** and hardening it for growth, with deep expertise in Platform Security, CI/CD automation, Istio, Kubernetes Operators, Observability, Production Incident handling, and Cost Optimization.

EXPERIENCE

Senior DevOps Engineer

ZZAZZ AI

Feb 2025 - Present

Cloud Migration: DigitalOcean → AWS

- Architected and led an **end-to-end DigitalOcean → AWS migration of multiple Kubernetes clusters and 200+ VMs in 30 days**, with **under 4 hours of cumulative downtime** and **zero data loss**, by standing up greenfield **multi-AZ EKS clusters** sustaining **~15K RPS** via a phased, pipeline-driven cutover.
- Codified the entire AWS landing zone in **Terraform (100% IaC)** — **VPC, subnetting, security groups, and least-privilege IAM** — and replatformed **managed and self-hosted databases** onto **AWS Graviton (ARM)**, delivering **~40% performance gains**, **~35% latency reduction**, and audit-ready change control.

Argus: AI Ops Chatbot

- Developed **Argus**, an internal AI Ops chatbot on **Kubernetes, Prometheus, and Grafana MCP servers**, reducing **MTTR by 75%** and unlocking self-serve cluster debugging, with an admin dashboard for token-cost and usage analytics.

Kubernetes Architecture & Observability

- Owned and architected **secure Kubernetes platform architecture from scratch** across **2 environments**, supporting **~150 microservices** at **~15K RPS per cluster**; introduced RBAC, network policies, namespace isolation, and multi-region clusters for GDPR compliance, and standardized deployments with reusable **Helm** templates for scalable self-service delivery.
- Drove an **OSS-first platform strategy** over vendor tooling across observability, CI/CD, certificate management, and orchestration; adopted **Helm, cert-manager, Kubernetes Operators**, and the **LGTM stack**, cutting licensing costs and avoiding vendor lock-in.
- Built the **platform-wide observability stack from the ground up** using **Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager**, and **Loki**; delivered team-specific alerting and dashboards covering nodes, pods, workloads, compute, and networking.

Self-Hosted GitLab & CI/CD at Scale

- Established and operationalized **self-hosted GitLab** for **50+ users, ~300 projects**, and **20k+ pipeline runs per month**; transferred **250+ repositories** from Bitbucket with zero data loss and added DR automation with **RPO ~24h, RTO ~1h**.
- Streamlined CI/CD on Kubernetes-based runners, cutting container image build times by **60–70%**, adding **GitLeaks** security scans, and introducing deployment guardrails such as central kill switches for safer releases.

ZTNA & Infrastructure Security

- Architected centralized identity and access management by rolling out **SSO and SCIM across 45+ tools and applications**, standardizing authentication and automating user lifecycle management organization-wide.
- Hardened platform access controls with **Cloudflare ZTNA across 500+ hosts**, **Cloudflared-backed authenticated test endpoints** for Kubernetes services, and **Cloudflare Warp** for **35+ developers and contractors**.

Cloudflare DNS & Workers

- Simplified ingress with dynamic DNS allocation and a **single shared load balancer** (eliminating **60+ LBs**), and transitioned **15+ frontend services** to **Cloudflare Workers and Pages** for standardized edge delivery and CI/CD.

EDUCATION

B.Tech in ICT: 8.31 CGPA

Dhirubhai Ambani Institute of Information and Communication Technology

2018 - 2022 Gandhinagar, India

STRENGTHS

- Kubernetes Platform Architecture
- Service Mesh & Traffic Management
- Observability & Incident Response
- Zero-Trust Security & Access Control
- End-to-End Ownership & On-Call Leadership
- Cross-Team Enablement & Collaboration
- Infrastructure Cost Optimization
- Technical Mentorship & Knowledge Sharing

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Cloud & Platforms:** AWS, DigitalOcean, Cloudflare
- Containers & Orchestration:** Kubernetes, Docker, Istio (service mesh)
- Programming:** Python, Bash
- Infrastructure as Code:** AWS CloudFormation, Helm, Terraform
- CI/CD:** GitLab Pipelines, ArgoCD, Jenkins*, GitLeaks
- Monitoring & Logging:** Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, Datadog*, Sumo Logic
- Security & Networking:** Cloudflare ZTNA & Warp, Infisical (secret management), DNS, OAuth, RBAC
- Tooling:** Git, WordPress, Jira, Slack Workflows, Airflow, JSM, Microsoft Entra ID*

* Elementary proficiency

Software Development Engineer-2 (DevOps)

Mindtickler

📅 Jan 2022 - Feb 2025

Istio

- Reduced inter-AZ data transfer costs by 70% through Istio locality-aware traffic management and expanded mesh visibility with **Grafana dashboards** for both control plane and data plane observability.
- Delivered **zero-downtime** Istio upgrades in production by introducing a **canary upgrade strategy** and transitioning mesh deployments to **Helm-based** version control.
- Operated **Istio service mesh** across multiple clusters serving **500+ microservices**, strengthening traffic control and production reliability for platform-managed services.

Cost-Saving Initiatives

- Replatformed Kubernetes workloads onto AWS Graviton-based instances through ARM image build and deployment pipelines, generating **\$270,000** in savings.
- Automated EC2 and EBS cleanup to remove redundant capacity, driving **\$100,000+ annual savings**.
- Developed migration and validation tooling to move **1000+ repositories from GitHub to GitLab** across 5 language ecosystems, saving **\$40,000 annually**.

Isolated Sandbox Testing

- Designed an isolated sandbox testing model for Kubernetes-native applications based on **Shift Left Testing**, driving a **40% reduction** in error rates before production rollout.
- Used **Kubernetes Operators** and Istio reliability features to make the solution repeatable and production-like, with plans to **open-source** the approach.

Chaos Testing Enhancements

- Engineered an **in-house** chaos testing mechanism using Kubernetes Operators and Istio fault injection to validate resiliency across **50+ microservices**.
- Extended resilience testing to infrastructure level with AWS Fault Injection Simulator on clusters spanning **150+ nodes**.

Automation & Developer Tooling

- Built a Slack workflow integrating **Jira**, **PagerDuty**, and **Google Meet** for incident escalation, and a custom Slackbot for access management and developer tasks — together **cutting manual workload by 30%** and saving **50+ hours/month**.
- Developed an internal portal routing **400+ on-call requests/month** through Jira Service Management; introduced **SLAs** and recurring issue reporting, reducing tickets by **10% month-over-month**.

FREELANCE PROJECT

Platform Architect (12,000+ Sites)

📅 2-month engagement

Platform Architecture & Cost Optimization

- Designed and delivered a Kubernetes-based hosting platform for **12,000+ internal websites**, reducing monthly hosting costs by **~\$25k/month**, from **~\$30k to ~\$5k/month**.
- Engineered the platform's **database layer, observability, security, and access controls** end-to-end, with automated **DNS, SSL certificate management**, and monitoring at 12,000-site scale.
- Optimized traffic-based performance with **Redis + local caching** and **Autoscaling**.

Automation & Operational Tooling

- Developed automation tooling for bulk content push and theme/plugin management at scale using custom scripts and **WP CLI**.
- Exposed **API endpoints** to automate operational website actions such as article publishing and plugin-driven workflows across the fleet.
- Coordinated delivery for demo and client-critical sites, handling access, plugin procurement, timelines, and end-to-end execution.

ENABLEMENT

- Partnered with the **AWS account and solutions team** through the migration lifecycle to negotiate **migration credits and committed-use discounts**, securing additional cost incentives on top of architectural savings.
- Served as **24x7 on-call engineer** across cloud, platform, and infrastructure, owning end-to-end production incident response.
- Authored onboarding docs and operational runbooks.
- Led knowledge-sharing sessions on Kubernetes debugging, Cloudflare Warp, and GitLeaks.
- Organized and led a week-long **Istio Workshop** for **250 developers**, improving service mesh awareness and adoption.
- Mentored junior engineers on platform and infrastructure practices.
- Conducted interviews for DevOps, SRE, Platform Engineering, DBA, WordPress, and related roles.

CREDENTIALS

- Received the **Employee of the Quarter (Q3 2025)** award for contributions to the platform team and overall organizational impact.
- **Won the Engineer's Choice Award for Q2 2023**, recognized for impactful contributions among **250+ developers**.
- Received the **Data-Driven[Team] Award for Q2 2023**, honoring significant cost-saving contributions.
- **Convener** of the Technical Support Committee (formerly the ICT Committee), leading a team of 8 members.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **CKA** – Certified Kubernetes Administrator ([link](#))
- **ICA** – Istio Certified Associate ([link](#))